compromise. “I believe we should try to work out such an agreement in time to meet the target day of January 1, 1963,” wrote Kennedy.[16]

Between the carrot of the test-ban treaty and the stick of Berlin, Kennedy reached for the carrot, but the stick would remain on his mind for weeks to come. Khrushchev would not respond. This turned out to be their last exchange before the American discovery of the surface-to-surface missiles, to which Kennedy had referred in his statement of September 4 as “offensive weapons.” Unbeknownst to Kennedy, they were already in Cuba.[17]